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5 Key Challenges Hindering Sri Lanka's Progress in Achieving the SDGs and Strategies to Overcome Them

1. Limited Investment in Sustainable Infrastructure

Sri Lanka faces difficulties in developing modern infrastructure such as clean transport systems, smart cities, and eco-friendly construction due to financial and technical limitations.

Strategies:

Encourage public-private partnerships for sustainable infrastructure projects

Seek international funding and technical support for green development

Prioritize long-term sustainable planning in national development programs

2. High Youth Unemployment and Skills Gap

Many young people struggle to find employment because the education system does not always match the needs of the modern job market.

Strategies:

Expand vocational and technical training opportunities

Promote entrepreneurship and innovation among youth

Strengthen links between universities and industries for skill development

3. Food Security and Agricultural Challenges

Agriculture remains a key sector, but Sri Lanka faces issues such as low productivity, rising costs, and threats from climate change.

Strategies:

Support farmers with modern technology and training

Promote sustainable farming methods and water conservation

Improve supply chains to reduce food waste and increase efficiency

4. Rapid Urbanization and Housing Problems

Growing urban populations have increased pressure on housing, sanitation, and public services, leading to informal settlements and poor living conditions.

Strategies:

Develop affordable housing programs with sustainable designs

Improve urban planning and waste management systems

Expand basic services such as clean water and sanitation in cities

5. Insufficient Data and Research for SDG Monitoring

Sri Lanka faces challenges in collecting accurate data and conducting research needed to track SDG progress effectively.

Strategies:

Strengthen national data systems and digital record keeping

Support universities and research institutions in sustainability studies

Improve coordination between government agencies for better reporting